Freshman A+

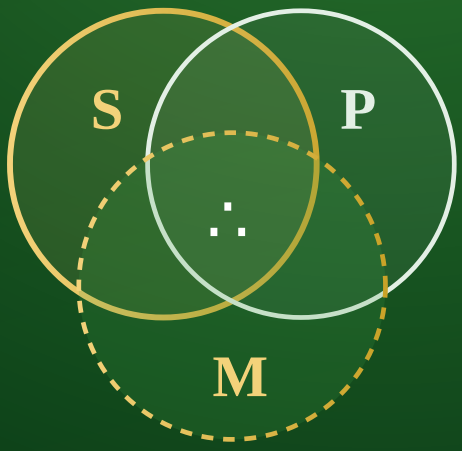
ETHIOPIAN UNIVERSITY FRESHMAN EXAM PREP

LESSON-BY-LESSON NOTES

Logic

& Critical Thinking

PHIL 1011 · CHAPTERS 1 – 5



THINK LIKE A LOGICIAN

P1 All Ethiopians are Africans.

P2 Tsionawit is an Ethiopian.

∴ **Tsionawit is an African.**

1. **Every concept, made simple**
   Short explanations, examples and diagrams
2. **Exam traps & memory aids**
   See where students lose marks, and how to avoid it
3. **Real university questions**
   Jigjiga · Salale · Oda Bultum & Hurley, all with answers explained

01 Introducing Philosophy

02 Basic Concepts of Logic

03 Logic and Language

04 Basic Concepts of Critical Thinking

05 Informal Fallacies

Based on the MoSHE **Logic and Critical Thinking** module and Hurley, *A Concise Introduction to Logic* (11th ed.)

Contents

Five chapters · lesson-by-lesson notes, exam traps, and university exam questions with full answers.

Chapter 1 **Introducing Philosophy** 2

1.1 Meaning and Nature of Philosophy 3
1.2 Basic Features of Philosophy 8
1.3 Metaphysics and Epistemology 12
1.4 Axiology and Logic 19
1.5 Importance of Learning Philosophy 24
★ *Quick revision & key tables* 28

Chapter 2 **Basic Concepts of Logic** 29

2.1 Arguments, Premises and Conclusions 30
2.2 Techniques of Recognizing Arguments 37
2.3 Types of Arguments: Deduction and Induction 47
2.4 Evaluating Arguments 55
★ *Quick revision & key tables* 66

Chapter 3 **Logic and Language** 67

3.1 Philosophy of Language: An Overview 68
3.2 Logic and Meaning 73
3.3 Meaning, Types and Purposes of Definitions 82
3.4 Techniques of Definition 88
3.5 Criteria for Lexical Definitions 96
★ *Quick revision & key tables* 101

Chapter 4 **Basic Concepts of Critical Thinking** 102

4.1 Meaning of Critical Thinking 103
4.2 Standards of Critical Thinking 108
4.3 Codes of Intellectual Conduct for Effective Discussion 112
4.4 Characteristics of Critical Thinking 117
4.5 Barriers to Critical Thinking 121
4.6 Benefits of Critical Thinking 128
★ *Quick revision & key tables* 131

Chapter 5 **Informal Fallacies** 132

5.1 Fallacy in General 133
5.2 Fallacies of Relevance 138
5.3 Fallacies of Weak Induction 152
5.4 Fallacies of Presumption 163
5.5 Fallacies of Ambiguity and Grammatical Analogy 170
★ *Quick revision & key tables* 178

HOW EACH LESSON IS BUILT

★ KEY IDEA
The main point you must remember.

! EXAM TRAP
Where students usually lose marks.

M MEMORY AID
A short trick to recall lists and pairs.

H FROM HURLEY
Extra insight from the reference book.

Question tags: University · Exam real past paper Hurley · Exercise reference book University · Model Exam prepared model question

CHAPTER

01

Introducing Philosophy

Before logic became a subject of its own, philosophers used it as a **tool** to study reality, knowledge and value. So we start with philosophy itself: what it means, how it differs from other subjects, its four core branches, and why studying it matters. Logic is one of those branches, and it is the main subject of this course.

LESSONS IN THIS CHAPTER

1.1 Meaning and Nature of Philosophy

1.2 Basic Features of Philosophy

1.3 Metaphysics and Epistemology

1.4 Axiology and Logic

1.5 Importance of Learning Philosophy

Freshman A+ · Logic & Critical Thinking (PHIL 1011)

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.1

Meaning and Nature of Philosophy

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Explain why philosophy is hard to define
- Give the etymological meaning of philosophy
- Describe the wisdom philosophers seek
- Explain the critical and constructive sides of philosophy

1.1.1 Why is philosophy hard to define?

Most subjects are easy to define because each has its **own subject matter**. Chemistry studies matter and its changes, and geography studies the earth and its people. Philosophy has **no specific subject matter**. It deals with **issues**, and those issues are **universal**: they appear in every field and every life.

This does not mean philosophy is impossible to understand. The module says the best way to learn philosophy is to **philosophize**:

- face philosophical questions yourself,
- use philosophical language,
- become familiar with different philosophical positions,
- read the philosophers themselves, and
- grapple with the issues for yourself.

> *"Wonder is the feeling of a philosopher, and philosophy begins in wonder."*
> — Socrates

All of us have felt this wonder. We all think about the things that matter most to us, so we all take part in philosophy *more or less*. But **thinking alone does not make us philosophers.**

! WONDER IS NOT ONLY FOR PHILOSOPHY STUDENTS

"Philosophy begins in wonder" does **not** mean that only philosophy students feel wonder. The module says *all of us* are "touched and moved by the feelings of wonder from which all philosophy derives." (Jigjiga Mid exam: **False**.)

1.1.2 The etymological meaning: "love of wisdom"

If you want a clear definition, go to the **origin of the word** (its etymology):



Two Greek words → the literal definition of philosophy

- **Pythagoras** was the first to use the word **"philosopher"**, for a person who shows *a marked curiosity in the things he experiences*.
- Anyone who asks *Does God exist? What is reality? What is knowledge? What is value?* shows this curiosity: a vital concern to become **wise** about the world and human experience.
- So **seeking wisdom** is one essence of philosophy. But the etymology alone is **not enough**, because *not all wisdom is philosophy*.

1.1.3 What kind of wisdom do philosophers seek?

The wisdom philosophers seek is **not** the expertise or technical skill of professionals. A person may know a great many facts (be "encyclopedic") and still be foolish about the **meaning and significance** of what he knows.

D SOCRATES' DEFINITION OF WISDOM

Wisdom consists of **a critical habit and eternal vigilance about all things**, and **a reverence for truth**, whatever its form and wherever its place.

Based on this, the module defines philosophy as a pursuit of wisdom:

★ PHILOSOPHY AS THE PURSUIT OF WISDOM

Philosophy is **(1) the development of critical habits, (2) the continuous search for truth, and (3) the questioning of the apparent.**

M REMEMBER "C – S – Q"

Critical habits · **S**earch for truth · **Q**uestioning the apparent. These three phrases appear in exam options again and again.

What does "questioning the apparent" mean?

To question (interrogate) the obvious means to:

- deal **creatively** with the phenomenal (observable) world,
- go **beyond the common understanding**, and
- **speculate** about things that other people accept without doubt.

! QUESTIONING ≠ DENYING REALITY

Questioning the apparent does **not** mean denying obvious facts or practical reality. And questioning is **not the final end** of philosophy. Raising the *right* question is its **beginning, direction and essence**: the art of seeing what is not readily obvious and imagining other possibilities.

> *"The philosophical enterprise is an active imaginative process of formulating proper questions and resolving them by rigorous, persistent analysis."*
>
> — Vincent Barry

1.1.4 A rational and critical enterprise with two sides

Philosophy is **a rational and critical enterprise** that tries to formulate and answer fundamental questions through an **intensive application of reason**: analysis, comparison and evaluation. It has two sides:

Side	What it does	Simple meaning
Constructive side	*Formulates rationally defensible answers* to fundamental questions about **reality, value, knowledge and truth**	It **builds** answers
Critical side	Gives *rational criticism, analysis, clarification and evaluation* of answers to metaphysical, epistemological and axiological questions	It **tests** answers

1.1.5 Philosophy is an activity

Philosophy cannot simply be mastered in school like a list of facts. A great philosopher is great **not because he mastered philosophy, but because he did it**: because of his extraordinary ability to think critically, conceptualize, analyze, compare, evaluate and understand. In one word, to **philosophize**.

> **IN SIMPLE WORDS**
>
> Philosophy is **both** a *product* (the ideas philosophers produced) **and** an *activity* (philosophizing). What makes someone a great philosopher is the **activity**, not the product.

Exam Practice

9 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.1

1 Jigjiga University · Mid 2016

"Philosophy begins in wonder" means that only students of philosophy are moved by wonder.

True / False

2 Jigjiga University · 2012

Defining the term philosophy is very easy using concrete terminology.

True / False

3 Oda Bultum University · Mid 2017 E.C.

Philosophy, as a rational and critical enterprise, sometimes requires exploring seemingly irrational concepts to push the boundaries of understanding.

True / False

4 Jigjiga University · 2012

The etymological meaning of philosophy is:

A) Philosophy is the love of wisdom, knowledge and art
B) Philosophy is the mother of all sciences
C) Philosophy is the science of questioning
D) Philosophy is an analytical science

5 Haramaya University · Model Exam

The ancient Greek thinker who first used the word "philosopher" was:

A) Aristotle
B) Plato
C) Pythagoras
D) Socrates

6 Haramaya University · Model Exam

According to Socrates, wisdom consists of:

A) Technical skill and the expertise of professionals
B) Encyclopedic knowledge of many facts
C) A critical habit, eternal vigilance about all things, and a reverence for truth
D) Obedience to tradition and authority

7 Jimma University · Model Exam

Which of the following is NOT part of the module's definition of philosophy as a pursuit of wisdom?

A) The development of critical habits
B) The continuous search for truth
C) The questioning of the apparent
D) The denial of practical reality

8 Adama Science and Technology University · Model Exam

"Philosophy formulates rationally defensible answers to fundamental questions about reality, value, knowledge and truth." This describes the:

A) constructive side of philosophy
B) informal sense of philosophy
C) linguistic function of philosophy
D) critical side of philosophy

9 Mekelle University · Model Exam

According to the module, what makes someone a great philosopher?

A) Producing many written works
B) Mastering all the theories of past philosophers
C) The outstanding ability to philosophize
D) Memorizing philosophical definitions

Answers & Explanations

1. False

The module says all of us are touched and moved by the feelings of wonder from which all philosophy derives. Wonder is human, not limited to philosophy students.

2. False

Philosophy has no specific subject matter; it deals with universal issues. That is why a clear-cut definition is difficult, and the module suggests the etymology ("love of wisdom") instead.

3. True

Philosophy questions the apparent and speculates beyond common understanding, including about things others accept without doubt.

4. A

Philosophy is the love of wisdom, knowledge and art

Only A contains "love of wisdom" (philo = love, sophia = wisdom). B, C and D describe philosophy but are not word-origin meanings. The extra words "knowledge and art" are a distraction; A is still the only etymological option.

5. C

Pythagoras

Pythagoras used "philosopher" for a person who shows a marked curiosity about the things he experiences.

6. C

A critical habit, eternal vigilance about all things, and a reverence for truth

The module rejects A and B: someone can be encyclopedic yet foolish about the meaning of what he knows. Tradition and authority (D) are never Socrates' test of wisdom.

7. D

The denial of practical reality

Remember C–S–Q. Questioning the apparent does not mean denying obvious facts or practical reality.

8. A

constructive side of philosophy

The constructive side **builds** answers. The critical side **evaluates** answers that have been given.

9. C

The outstanding ability to philosophize

"A philosopher is a great philosopher, not because he mastered philosophy, but because he did it." The product is philosophy; the greatness lies in the activity of philosophizing.

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.2

Basic Features of Philosophy

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- List the five general features of philosophy
- Distinguish "having" from "doing" philosophy
- Explain why philosophers disagree
- Tell a philosophical question from a question of fact

1.2.1 The five general features

The module summarizes philosophy in **five features**. Each one is a different "angle" on the same subject.

#	Feature	Short meaning
1	A set of views or beliefs about life and the universe, **often held uncritically**	**Informal** sense: "*having*" a philosophy ("My philosophy is...")
2	A process of **reflecting on and criticizing** our most deeply held conceptions and beliefs	**Formal** sense: "*doing*" philosophy
3	A **rational attempt to look at the world as a whole**	Combines the sciences and human experience into one consistent **worldview**
4	The **logical analysis of language** and clarification of the meaning of words and concepts	Clarifying terms; some call this the *only* task of philosophy
5	A group of **perennial problems** that interest people and for which philosophers have always sought answers	Deep, lasting questions: truth, right and wrong, God, life after death

M "HAVE, DO, WHOLE, WORDS, FOREVER"

1 **Have** a philosophy → 2 **Do** philosophy → 3 see the **Whole** world → 4 analyse **Words** → 5 problems that last **Forever** (perennial).

1.2.2 "Having" versus "doing" philosophy

★ HAVING A PHILOSOPHY (INFORMAL)

A personal attitude or set of beliefs, often held **uncritically**. Example: "My philosophy is to work hard and stay humble."

★ DOING PHILOSOPHY (FORMAL)

Reflecting on and criticizing our deepest beliefs. A genuine philosophical attitude is **searching, critical, open-minded and tolerant**.

The two cannot be separated completely: if we did not first *have* beliefs, we would have nothing to *do* philosophy on. But **having a philosophy is not sufficient for doing philosophy.** To philosophize you

must master skills of argumentation and techniques of analysis. To philosophize also means to **generalize** and to take a *second look* at what common sense presents.

> **! KNOWING MANY FACTS ≠ UNDERSTANDING**
> "The accumulation of knowledge does not by itself lead to understanding," because it does not teach the mind to **critically evaluate** facts.

1.2.3 Why do philosophers disagree?

The module gives **three reasons**:

1. **Different points of view and assumptions**: different personal experiences, cultural backgrounds and training, especially across times and places.
2. **A changing universe**: people, society and nature change. Some people adapt to change; others cling to tradition and old authoritative systems.
3. **Incomplete evidence**: philosophers deal with areas of experience where the evidence is not complete, so people interpret it differently.

> **M "VIEW, CHANGE, GAPS"**
> Different **views** · a world that **changes** · **gaps** in the evidence.

1.2.4 Looking at the world as a whole

Philosophers want to see life not with the *specialized slant* of the scientist, businessperson or artist, but as a **totality**. Philosophy tries to **integrate** the results of religious, historical and scientific inquiry into one **consistent worldview**.

1.2.5 Analysis of language

Nearly all philosophers clarify the meanings of terms. Some say this is the **main** task of philosophy, and a few claim it is the **only** legitimate task. That narrower view (strong in the 20th century) limits knowledge to statements about **observable facts** and their relations, and aims to *expose confusion and nonsense*.

1.2.6 Perennial problems

> **E FACT OR PHILOSOPHY?**
> - "Did Ram make a false statement on his income tax return?" → a **question of fact**.
> - "What is truth?" "What is the distinction between right and wrong?" → **philosophical** questions.

Attempts to answer such questions produced **schools of thought** (idealism, realism, pragmatism, analytic philosophy, existentialism, phenomenology, process philosophy) and the systems of great

philosophers such as Socrates, Plato, Aristotle, Augustine, Aquinas, Descartes, Locke, Kant, Hegel and Dewey.

Exam Practice

7 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.2

1 Jigjiga University · Mid 2016

Fill in the blank: "_____ is a group of perennial problems that interest people and for which philosophers always have sought answers."

2 Bahir Dar University · Model Exam

When a person says "My philosophy is never to lend money to friends," he is using philosophy in the sense of:

A) logical analysis of language
B) having a philosophy (informal sense)
C) a rational attempt to see the world as a whole
D) doing philosophy (formal sense)

3 Bahir Dar University · Model Exam

Which statement about "having" and "doing" philosophy is correct?

A) Doing philosophy means holding beliefs uncritically
B) They are completely independent of each other
C) Having a philosophy is sufficient for doing philosophy
D) We could not do philosophy if we did not first have a philosophy, but having one is not enough

4 Wollo University · Model Exam

All of the following are reasons the module gives for disagreement among philosophers EXCEPT:

A) They view things from different points of view and assumptions
B) They live in a changing universe
C) The evidence in their area of experience is incomplete
D) Philosophers deliberately avoid agreeing with each other

5 Hawassa University · Model Exam

Which of the following is a philosophical question rather than a question of fact?

A) Did Ram make a false statement on his tax return?
B) How many regions does Ethiopia have?
C) What is the distinction between right and wrong?
D) When did the Battle of Adwa take place?

6 Arsi University · Model Exam

The feature of philosophy that seeks to integrate the knowledge of the sciences with that of other disciplines into a consistent worldview is:

A) Philosophy as perennial problems
B) Philosophy as a rational attempt to look at the world as a whole
C) Philosophy as logical analysis of language
D) Philosophy as a set of uncritical beliefs

7 Dilla University · Model Exam

According to the module, the accumulation of knowledge by itself leads to understanding.

True / False

Answers & Explanations

1. Philosophy

This is the fifth general feature of philosophy in the module.

2. B

having a philosophy (informal sense)

"My philosophy is..." refers to an informal personal attitude, often held uncritically. That is "having" a philosophy.

3. D

We could not do philosophy if we did not first have a philosophy, but having one is not enough

The two senses cannot be treated as entirely independent, yet having a philosophy is not sufficient. Doing philosophy requires skills of argumentation and analysis.

4. D

Philosophers deliberately avoid agreeing with each other

The three reasons are different viewpoints, a changing universe and incomplete evidence. D is invented.

5. C

What is the distinction between right and wrong?

A, B and D can be settled by checking facts. "What is the distinction between right and wrong?" is a perennial philosophical problem, and it is the module's own example.

6. B

Philosophy as a rational attempt to look at the world as a whole

Feature 3 rejects the "specialized slant" of the scientist or artist and aims at a view of life as a totality.

7. False

The module says the accumulation of knowledge does not by itself lead to understanding, because it does not teach the mind to critically evaluate facts.

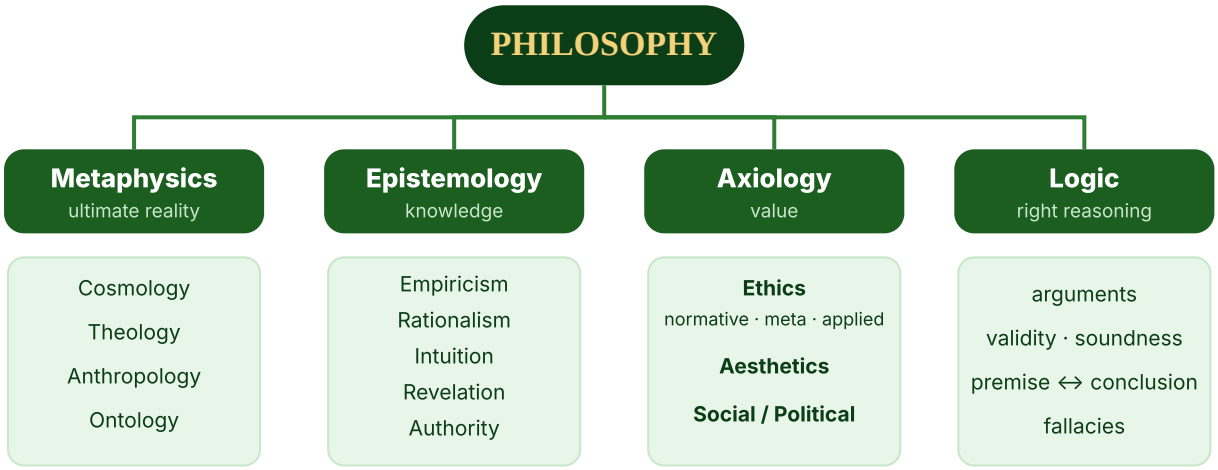
CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.3

Metaphysics and Epistemology

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Define metaphysics and give its origin
- Name the four aspects of metaphysics
- Define epistemology and its central issues
- Compare the five sources of knowledge

The module studies only the four **primary (core) branches** of philosophy: **Metaphysics, Epistemology, Axiology and Logic**. Van Cleve Morris said the key is asking the **"right"** questions, meaning questions that are meaningful and relevant and that make a difference in how people live.



The four core branches of philosophy and what sits under each

1.3.1 Metaphysics: the study of ultimate reality

D METAPHYSICS

The branch of philosophy that studies **the ultimate nature of reality or existence**. It deals with reality, God, freedom, the soul and immortality, the mind–body problem, form and substance, and cause and effect.

Origin of the word. Greek *meta* ("beyond", "upon", "after") + *physika* ("physics"), so literally *"the things after the physics"*. Aristotle's writings on "first philosophy" came **after** his treatise on physics, so his editor **Andronicus of Rhodes** named them *metaphysics*. Metaphysicians look for an irreducible foundation of reality, the **"first principles"**.

Typical metaphysical questions: What is reality? Is it one thing or many? Can reality be grasped by the senses, or is it transcendent? What is the mind and its relation to the body? Does God exist? Are human actions free or predetermined? What is time? What is the meaning of life?

E **GEORGE KNIGHT'S FLOOR**

What is the floor you stand on? To you it is flat, solid, smooth wood or concrete. To a **physicist** it is molecules → atoms → electrons, protons and neutrons → finally *electric energy*. To a **chemist** it is hydrocarbons reacting with heat, cold, wetness and oxidation. **Lesson:** "What is real?" is not as simple as it looks. Metaphysical questions are the **most basic**, because all later inquiry rests on them.

The four aspects (subsets) of metaphysics

Aspect	Studies	Typical questions
Cosmological	Origin, nature and development of the **universe** as an orderly system	How did the universe begin? By accident or design? Does it have a purpose?
Theological	Conceptions of and about **God**	Is there a God? One or many? If God is all-good and all-powerful, why does evil exist?
Anthropological	**Human beings**	Mind–body relation? Are people born good, evil or neutral? Free will or determinism? Is there a soul?
Ontological	The nature of **existence**, what it means for anything to exist	Is reality matter or spirit? One, two or many elements? Orderly in itself, or ordered by the mind? Fixed or changing?

M **"C-T-A-O": "CATS THINK ABOUT ONTOLOGY"**

Cosmology (universe) · **T**heology (God) · **A**nthropology (humans) · **O**ntology (existence).

1.3.2 Epistemology: the theory of knowledge

D **EPISTEMOLOGY**

The branch that studies **the nature, scope, meaning and possibility of knowledge**, also called the **"theory of knowledge"**. From Greek *episteme* ("knowledge, understanding") + *logos* ("study of"). It asks "What is true?" and "How do we know?"

Epistemology covers **two areas: the content of thought and thought itself.** It deals with the **dependability** of knowledge and the **validity of the sources** through which we gain information.

Typical questions: What is knowledge? What does it mean to know? Is the source of knowledge experience, reason or both? How is knowledge different from belief or opinion? What is the relationship between faith and reason?

Central issues in epistemology

1. **Can reality be known at all? Skepticism** (in its narrow sense) says people *cannot* acquire reliable knowledge, so any search for truth is in vain. **Gorgias** the Sophist said *nothing exists; and if it did, we could not know it.* A full-blown skepticism would make intelligent action impossible.

2. **Agnosticism**, a term close to skepticism, is a *profession of ignorance* about the **existence or nonexistence of God** ("I do not know whether God exists").
3. **Is truth relative or absolute?** Relative truth can change with time and place; **Absolute Truth** is eternally and universally true.
4. **Is knowledge subjective or objective?** Is there truth independent of human experience?

> **AGNOSTIC ≠ ATHEIST ≠ SKEPTIC**
>
> **Agnostic:** "I don't know whether God exists." **Atheist:** "God does not exist." **Skeptic:** "No reliable knowledge at all is possible." Exams use the agnostic's words exactly.

The five sources of knowledge

Source	Meaning	Strength	Weakness
Empiricism	Knowledge obtained **through the senses**	Immediate and universal; experiments can be **replicated** and publicly examined	Senses are incomplete and undependable (a stick looks bent in water); fatigue and illness distort
Rationalism	**Reason, thought or logic** is the central factor; the mind organizes raw sensations	Logical systems have **internal consistency**	Risk of being **disconnected from the external world**; only as valid as their premises
Intuition	**Direct apprehension** of knowledge, not from conscious reasoning or sense perception: a "sudden flash of insight"	Can **bypass the limits of human experience**; started many scientific breakthroughs	Not safe **when used alone**; goes astray easily unless checked by other methods
Revelation	Knowledge from a **transcendent supernatural reality** breaking into the natural order (God's communication)	Believers see it as an **omniscient** source not available otherwise	Must be accepted **by faith**; cannot be proved or disproved empirically; can be distorted in human interpretation
Authority *(not a philosophical position)*	Accepted as true because it comes from **experts** or long tradition (textbook, teacher)	Civilization would **stagnate** if everyone had to verify everything personally	If built on wrong assumptions, the knowledge is **distorted**

> **SOURCES ARE COMPLEMENTARY**
>
> No single source supplies all knowledge, so the module sees the sources as **complementary rather than antagonistic**. Most people choose one as a benchmark; today, **empirical** knowledge is generally seen as the most basic and reliable.

M **"ERIRA": "EVERY READER IS REALLY ALERT"**

Empiricism (senses) · **R**ationalism (reason) · **I**ntuition (flash) · **R**evelation (God) · **A**uthority (experts).

Exam Practice

14 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.3

1 Jigjiga University · Mid 2016

A major aspect of epistemology relates to the sources of human knowledge.

True / False

2 Jigjiga University · 2012

Metaphysics is the study of the nature, source and scope of knowledge.

True / False

3 Jigjiga University · 2012

Ontology is the study of the nature of existence, or what it means for anything to exist.

True / False

4 Jigjiga University · Mid 2016

A source of knowledge that emphasizes humanity's power of thought and the mind's contribution to knowledge, and claims that the senses alone cannot give universal, valid judgments, is:

A) Rationalism
B) Intuition
C) Empiricism
D) Revelation

5 Jigjiga University · 2012

Which one is odd?

A) Revelation
B) Ontology
C) Theology
D) Cosmology

6 Salale University · Mid 2015

Which is a key question of epistemology?

A) Is euthanasia morally wrong?
B) What does it mean to know?
C) How did the universe originate?
D) What is beauty?

7 Salale University · Mid 2015

Which is a key question of metaphysics?

A) What is the nature of ultimate reality?
B) What do ethical terms like "good" mean?
C) What makes an argument valid?
D) What is art?

8 Jigjiga University · Mid 2014

Which of the following is included in "metaphysics" (printed as "metaphors" on the paper)?

A) Opinion
B) Mind–body problem
C) False

9 Jigjiga University · Mid 2016

Fill in the blank: "_____ deals with issues related to the dependability of knowledge and the validity of the sources through which we gain information."

10 Jigjiga University · 2012

Match: (1) Rationalism, (2) Empiricism, (3) Intuition, (4) Cosmology, (5) Theology with: A. sense experience is the source of knowledge; B. direct apprehension of knowledge; C. origin, nature and development of the universe; D. nature and existence of God; E. reason is the primary source of knowledge.

11 Borana University · Model Exam

A person who says, "I do not know whether God exists or not," is professing:

A) agnosticism
B) skepticism about all knowledge
C) atheism
D) rationalism

12 Gondar University · Model Exam

"Nothing exists; and if it did, we could not know it." This view, which belongs to skepticism, was held by:

A) Andronicus of Rhodes
B) Gorgias
C) Socrates
D) Pythagoras

13 Gondar University · Model Exam

The name "metaphysics" was given to Aristotle's "first philosophy" by:

A) Pythagoras
B) Gorgias
C) Plato
D) Andronicus of Rhodes

14 Jimma University · Model Exam

Which source of knowledge "has the distinct advantage of being able to bypass the limitations of human experience" but is dangerous when used alone?

A) Intuition
B) Empiricism
C) Authority
D) Revelation

Answers & Explanations

1. True

The module says this word for word, then discusses empiricism, rationalism, intuition, revelation and authority.

2. False

That describes **epistemology**. Metaphysics studies the ultimate nature of reality or existence.

3. True

This is the module's exact definition of ontology, one of the four aspects of metaphysics.

4. A

Rationalism

This is the module's description of rationalism. Intuition is a sudden flash of insight; empiricism says knowledge comes through the senses, the opposite claim.

5. A

Revelation

Ontology, theology and cosmology are all aspects of **metaphysics**. Revelation is a **source of knowledge**, which belongs to epistemology.

6. B

What does it mean to know?

A belongs to ethics (axiology), C to cosmology (metaphysics) and D to aesthetics (axiology).

7. A

What is the nature of ultimate reality?

B is meta-ethics, C is logic and D is aesthetics.

8. B

Mind–body problem

The module lists "the mind–body problem" among the issues of metaphysics. Opinion relates to epistemology (knowledge versus opinion), and "false" is a truth value studied in logic.

9. Epistemology

The module's own wording about epistemology.

10. **1-E, 2-A, 3-B, 4-C, 5-D**

Rationalism = reason; empiricism = senses; intuition = direct apprehension; cosmology = universe; theology = God.

11. **A**

agnosticism

Agnosticism is a profession of ignorance about the existence or nonexistence of God. A skeptic doubts all reliable knowledge, not only knowledge about God.

12. **B**

Gorgias

Gorgias the Sophist expressed full skepticism. The module adds that a full-blown skepticism would make intelligent action impossible.

13. **D**

Andronicus of Rhodes

The writings came after Aristotle's treatise on physics, so his editor, Andronicus of Rhodes, called them meta ta physika, "after the physics".

14. **A**

Intuition

That is the module's assessment of intuition. Revelation's main weakness is that it must be accepted by faith and cannot be proved or disproved empirically.

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.4

Axiology and Logic

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Define axiology and name its three areas
- Distinguish normative ethics, meta-ethics and applied ethics
- State what aesthetics and social/political philosophy ask
- Define logic as a branch of philosophy

1.4.1 Axiology: the study of value

D AXIOLOGY

The philosophical **study or theory of value**, where value originally meant **the worth of something**. From Greek *axios* ("value, worth") + *logos* ("reason, theory, study of").

Axiology asks what a person or society regards as **good or preferable**: What is a value? Where do values come from? How do we justify our values? What is the relationship between values and knowledge? Can one value be shown to be better than another?

! AXIOLOGY IS NOT "THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN VALUES AND KNOWLEDGE"

That is only **one question** axiology asks. Defining axiology as "the study of the relationship between values and knowledge" is **too narrow** (Jigjiga 2012: **False**). And axiology is not the study of ultimate reality; that is metaphysics.

Axiology works in **three areas**:

I. Ethics (moral philosophy)

Ethics studies the **moral principles, values, codes and rules** used as standards to decide whether human conduct is **good or bad, right or wrong**. It has three branches:

Branch	What it studies	Examples (from the module)
Normative ethics	Determines the **moral rules, principles, standards and goals** by which we judge conduct: *which acts are right?*	**Consequentialism** (teleological), **deontological** ethics, **virtue** ethics
Meta-ethics	Highly technical: the **meaning of ethical terms** ("good", "right") and how ethical statements can be **verified**	Moral **intuitionism**, **emotivism**, **prescriptivism**, **nihilism**, ethical **relativism**
Applied ethics	**Applies** general moral principles to **specific moral problems**	Capital punishment, euthanasia, abortion, adultery, animal rights

M SORT THEM FAST

Normative = what we OUGHT to do (theories ending in *-ism of action*: consequentialism, deontology, virtue).
Meta = what moral WORDS mean (the emotive *-isms*: intuitionism, emotivism, prescriptivism, nihilism, relativism).
Applied = real CASES (euthanasia, abortion, death penalty).

II. Aesthetics

Aesthetics is the theory of beauty. It studies the value of our artistic and aesthetic experiences: **beauty, art, enjoyment, sensory and emotional values, perception, and matters of taste and sentiment.** Questions: What is art? What is beauty? Is beauty objective or subjective? Does art have moral value? Are there standards of quality in art?

III. Social and political philosophy

It studies the **value judgments operating in a civil society**: What form of government is best? What economic system is best? What is justice? Are we obligated to obey all laws of the state? What is the purpose of government?

1.4.2 Logic as a branch of philosophy

D LOGIC (CHAPTER 1 DEFINITION)

The study or theory of principles of right reasoning. It formulates the right principles of reasoning and develops **scientific methods of evaluating the validity and soundness of arguments.**

Questions of logic: What is an argument? What makes an argument valid or invalid? What is a sound argument? What relation do premise and conclusion have? What is a fallacy? You will study all of these in Chapters 2 and 5.

Exam Practice

10 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.4

1 Jigjiga University · Mid 2016

Fill in the blank: "_____ ethics tries to determine the moral rules, principles, standards and goals by which human conduct is judged."

2 Jigjiga University · Mid 2014

Which of the following belongs to meta-ethics?

A) Virtue ethics
B) Teleological ethics
C) Moral nihilism

3 Jigjiga University · 2012

Axiology is the study of the relationship between values and knowledge.

True / False

4 Oda Bultum University · Mid 2017 E.C.

Axiology is the study of ultimate reality.

True / False

5 Jigjiga University · 2012

Which one is TRUE?

A) Axiology studies solely rational values
B) Metaphysics studies the limits of knowledge
C) Aesthetics studies not only beauty but also works of art
D) Logic evaluates the truth of single statements

6 Jigjiga University · 2012

In a dialogue, Anderson admires a mountain's "artistic view", as if a good architect had designed it. This implies which branch of philosophy?

A) Metaphysics **B)** Aesthetics
C) Nihilism **D)** Skepticism

7 Salale University · Mid 2015

Which is a key question of axiology?

A) What is ultimately real? **B)** How do we know?
C) What makes an argument valid? **D)** What is value?

8 Debre Markos University · Model Exam

A philosopher writes a paper arguing whether euthanasia is morally permissible for terminally ill patients. Which branch of ethics is this?

A) Aesthetics **B)** Meta-ethics
C) Applied ethics **D)** Normative theory of virtue

9 Debre Markos University · Model Exam

"What does the word 'good' mean, and how can a moral statement be verified?" This question belongs to:

A) Meta-ethics **B)** Applied ethics
C) Normative ethics **D)** Social philosophy

10 Ambo University · Model Exam

"What form of government is best, and are we obligated to obey all laws of the state?" These questions belong to:

A) Epistemology
B) Social/political philosophy
C) Cosmology
D) Aesthetics

Answers & Explanations

1. **Normative**

Normative ethics is the reasoned search for principles of conduct. Its examples are consequentialism, deontology and virtue ethics.

2. **C**

Moral nihilism

The module lists intuitionism, emotivism, prescriptivism, **nihilism** and ethical relativism as meta-ethics. Virtue ethics and teleological (consequentialist) ethics are normative.

3. **False**

Axiology is the study of value in general (ethics, aesthetics, social and political philosophy). That relationship is only one of the questions it raises.

4. **False**

Ultimate reality is the subject of **metaphysics**. Axiology studies value.

5. **C**

Aesthetics studies not only beauty but also works of art

Aesthetics deals with "beauty, art, enjoyment...". A is too narrow, B describes epistemology, and logic evaluates arguments (whether premises support a conclusion), not single statements.

6. **B**

Aesthetics

Appreciating beauty and artistic quality is aesthetics, "the theory of beauty". Nihilism is a meta-ethical view and skepticism an epistemological one.

7. **D**

What is value?

A is metaphysics, B is epistemology and C is logic.

8. **C**

Applied ethics

Applied ethics applies general moral principles to specific problems such as euthanasia, abortion and capital punishment.

9. A

Meta-ethics

Meta-ethics is concerned with the **meaning** of ethical terms and how ethical statements can be verified, not with which acts are actually good.

10. B

Social/political philosophy

Social and political philosophy studies the value judgments operating in civil society, such as government, justice and law.

CHAPTER 1 · LESSON 1.5

Importance of Learning Philosophy

AFTER THIS LESSON YOU CAN

- Explain Socrates' "unexamined life"
- Distinguish maintenance and actualizing needs
- List the five characteristics of self-actualization philosophy supports
- Explain Russell's view on the value of uncertainty

1.5.1 "The unexamined life is not worth living"

> *"…to let no day pass without discussing goodness and all the other subjects about which you hear me talking and examining both myself and others is really the best thing that a man can do, and life without this sort of examination is not worth living."*
>
> — Socrates

Meaning: philosophy gives us **the tools to critically examine our own lives and the world we live in.** A life becomes meaningful when it is examined and challenged.

1.5.2 Philosophy and self-actualization

Some modern psychologists say humans have two kinds of needs:

MAINTENANCE NEEDS

Physical and psychological needs we must satisfy to **maintain ourselves**: food, shelter, security, social interaction.

ACTUALIZING NEEDS

Needs for **self-fulfillment**: creativity, self-expression, realizing one's potential, *being everything one can be*.

Philosophy may not *automatically* produce self-actualization, but it **promotes the ideal** of it by helping us achieve these five characteristics:

#	Characteristic	How philosophy helps
1	**Intellectual and behavioral independence**	The ability to develop one's **own** opinions and beliefs; integrate experiences into a unified, coherent worldview
2	**Reflective self-awareness**	Critically examining the intellectual grounds of our lives deepens knowledge of **oneself**
3	**Flexibility, tolerance and open-mindedness**	Meeting many perspectives shows that the value of an attitude is often contextual, so we become more receptive to opposing views
4	**Creative and critical thinking**	Refines our powers of analysis, reasoning, evaluating, theorizing and justifying

#	Characteristic	How philosophy helps
5	**Well-thought-out value systems** (morality, art, politics)	Helps us evaluate values and find **meaning** in our lives

"I-R-F-C-V": "I REALLY FEEL CLEVER VERY OFTEN"

Independence · **R**eflective self-awareness · **F**lexibility and tolerance · **C**reative and critical thinking · **V**alue systems.

1.5.3 Philosophy helps us deal with uncertainty

Philosophy helps us realize that there is **no absolutely certain knowledge**. Why is that useful? Bertrand Russell answers in *The Problems of Philosophy*:

> *"The man who has no tincture of philosophy goes through life imprisoned in the prejudices derived from common sense, from the habitual beliefs of his age or his nation, and from convictions which have grown up in his mind without the cooperation or consent of his deliberate reason… Philosophy, though unable to tell us with certainty what is the true answer to the doubts which it raises, is able to suggest many possibilities which enlarge our thoughts and free them from the tyranny of custom."*
>
> — Bertrand Russell (1912)

WHAT RUSSELL IS SAYING

Philosophy **reduces our false certainty** about *what things are*, but **greatly increases our knowledge of what they may be**. It removes **dogmatism** (arrogant certainty) and keeps alive our **sense of wonder** by showing familiar things in an unfamiliar light.

Exam Practice

7 QUESTIONS · LESSON 1.5

1 Jigjiga University · 2012

What does Socrates mean by "the unexamined life is not worth living"?

A) For life to be meaningful, it must be examined (challenged)
B) Life is worth living only if one withstands hardships
C) Life is meaningful only if one meets many problems

2 Jigjiga University · Mid 2014

"The unexamined life is not worth living." This implies:

A) The importance of philosophy in human life
B) An obligation to discuss goodness before death
C) Life is bitter and meaningless without knowledge
D) Life is a continuous journey

3 Jigjiga University · Mid 2014

One can gain all of the following by learning philosophy EXCEPT:

A) Examining one's own life
B) Taking and accepting any issue with or without logic
C) Dealing with the uncertainty of living
D) Questioning the apparent

4 Borana University · Model Exam

According to Russell, a man with no tincture of philosophy goes through life imprisoned in:

A) logical systems
B) scientific theories
C) prejudices derived from common sense, the habitual beliefs of his age or nation, and unexamined convictions
D) religious revelation only

5 Wolkite University · Model Exam

Food, shelter, security and social interaction are examples of:

A) maintenance needs
B) reflective self-awareness
C) actualizing needs
D) value systems

6 Wolkite University · Model Exam

Which of the following is NOT one of the characteristics of self-actualization that studying philosophy helps us achieve?

A) Intellectual and behavioral independence
B) Reflective self-awareness
C) Flexibility, tolerance and open-mindedness
D) Blind loyalty to tradition

7 Mizan-Tepi University · Model Exam

According to Russell, the value of philosophy is partly found in its very uncertainty.

True / False

Answers & Explanations

1. **A**

For life to be meaningful, it must be examined (challenged)

Socrates meant that life gains its worth through critically examining oneself and others. Endurance (B) and meeting problems (C) are not the same as examination.

2. A

The importance of philosophy in human life

The module uses the quote to introduce the importance of studying philosophy. B takes it too literally, C overstates it, and D is not the module's reading.

3. B

Taking and accepting any issue with or without logic

Philosophy teaches the opposite of B: critical examination and accepting claims only for good reasons.

4. C

prejudices derived from common sense, the habitual beliefs of his age or nation, and unexamined convictions

Russell lists common sense, the habitual beliefs of one's age or nation, and convictions formed without deliberate reason.

5. A

maintenance needs

Maintenance needs keep us going as human beings. Actualizing needs concern self-fulfillment and realizing one's potential.

6. D

Blind loyalty to tradition

Philosophy frees thought "from the tyranny of custom". Blind loyalty to tradition is the opposite of what it promotes.

7. True

"The value of philosophy is, in part, to be sought largely in its very uncertainty." It removes dogmatism and enlarges our thoughts.

CHAPTER 1 · QUICK REVISION

Introducing Philosophy — at a glance

The core branches in one table

Branch	Studies	Remember with
Metaphysics	Ultimate nature of reality and existence	Cosmology · Theology · Anthropology · Ontology
Epistemology	Nature, scope, meaning and possibility of knowledge	Empiricism · Rationalism · Intuition · Revelation · Authority
Axiology	Value (worth)	Ethics (normative / meta / applied) · Aesthetics · Social-political
Logic	Principles of right reasoning	Arguments · validity · soundness · fallacies

Must-know names and words

Name / term	Why it appears in exams
Pythagoras	First to use the word "philosopher"
Socrates	"Philosophy begins in wonder"; wisdom = critical habit + eternal vigilance + reverence for truth; "The unexamined life is not worth living"
Vincent Barry	Philosophy is "an active imaginative process of formulating proper questions and resolving them by rigorous, persistent analysis"
Van Cleve Morris	The crux is asking the "right" (meaningful, relevant) questions
Andronicus of Rhodes	Named Aristotle's "first philosophy" *metaphysics*
George Knight	The floor example: "What is real?" is not simple
Gorgias	Skeptic: nothing exists; if it did, we could not know it
Bertrand Russell	The value of philosophy lies partly in its uncertainty; it frees us from the "tyranny of custom"
Agnosticism	Profession of ignorance about the existence of God

FIVE CLASSIC MIX-UPS

1. Metaphysics = reality; **epistemology** = knowledge.
2. Axiology ≠ "values and knowledge" only (too narrow).
3. Questioning the apparent ≠ denying reality.
4. Virtue and consequentialist ethics are **normative**; nihilism and emotivism are **meta-ethics**.
5. Revelation is a source of **knowledge**, not an aspect of metaphysics.